

BILLY BISHOP AIRPORT: EXPLAINED

HOW IS FORD PLANNING TO EXPAND THE AIRPORT?

On April 23, 2026 Premier Ford introduced Bill 110 *Building Billy Bishop Airport Act*, which would enable the province to take over City-owned airport lands and replace Toronto's role in the Tripartite Agreement. The provincial Act would expand the runway for jets by making Billy Bishop a 'Special Economic Zone,' a designation which allows the province to side-step provincial and municipal planning and environmental regulations.

WHAT IS THE TRIPARTITE AGREEMENT?

Signed in 1983 by the City, federal government, and Toronto Port Authority, the Tripartite Agreement governs Billy Bishop Airport's operations. All three parties must agree on changes such as runway or landmass expansion, types of aircrafts, noise levels, and operating hours.

WHAT IS THE TORONTO PORT AUTHORITY?

The Toronto Port Authority (TPA) is a federal government 'business enterprise' that owns and operates the island airport, the Outer Harbour Marina, the port of Toronto, and various properties along the water's edge. The island airport remains the primary reason TPA exists.

WHO OWNS THE AIRPORT?

The airport's ownership is divided between the airport's operations, the land it sits on, and the passenger terminal. The airport is owned and operated by the Toronto Port Authority; the land is owned primarily by the Port Authority as well as the City and the federal government; and the passenger terminal is owned and managed by Nieuport Aviation, a private infrastructure consortium.

I HEARD BIG AMERICAN BANKS ARE INVOLVED...

Nieuport Aviation is currently owned by 'institutional investors' advised by J.P. Morgan Asset Management. Multiple articles (National Observer, Globe and Mail) have made the connection that J.P. Morgan-controlled companies would stand to benefit from an airport expansion.

CAN THE PROVINCE JUST TAKE CITY-OWNED LAND?

Unfortunately, yes. Under Ontario's Expropriations Act, the provincial government has the power to take land for what it considers a 'public purpose,' including land owned by a municipality. This was part of what happened at Ontario Place.

Calls to Action...

WE ENCOURAGE YOU TO WRITE YOUR REPRESENTATIVES AT ALL THREE LEVELS OF GOVERNMENT ABOUT THE PROPOSED AIRPORT EXPANSION:

1. Contact your **Municipal** City Councillor: tinyurl.com/TO-municipal

Why? Mayor Olivia Chow and many city councillors have voiced opposition, but is it loud enough? Can we make it louder?

2. Contact your Member of **Provincial** Parliament: tinyurl.com/ON-provincial

Why? The Ford government has a majority so could easily pass Bill 110, yet only a handful of Toronto NDP MPPs (Chris Glover, Kristin Wong-Tam, Alexa Gilmour, Jessica Bell) have been raising concerns and asking questions in committee review of the bill. This issue needs to become top of mind for more MPPs ASAP.

3. Contact your **Federal** Member of Parliament: tinyurl.com/CA-federal

Why? The Federal Toronto Liberal Caucus (23 MPs representing Toronto) has thus far been suspiciously quiet on the topic! The chair of the caucus, Julie Dzerowicz, has at least publicly stated that any changes to the airport require unanimous approval from all Tripartite Agreement partners and that any changes to the airport require unanimous approval from all Tripartite Agreement partners and will involve “meaningful consultation.”



Fill out No Jets TO's form to automatically tell your provincial representatives that this is the wrong plan for our waterfront.

ALSO CHECK OUT:

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@FriendsofHanlans
@birdingtonto



Sign the petition calling on the federal government to exercise its authority as a signatory in the Tripartite Agreement and block Ford's power-grab.